MATHEMATICS PREMIER LEAGUE (MPL) 2026

Gameplay & Rules

1. Event Overview

The Mathematics Premier League (MPL) combines the excitement of cricket with the challenge of mathematics. Every ball represents a mathematical question, and every correct answer earns runs for the batting team. Players face different types of balls, each testing their speed, accuracy, and problem-solving skills. From easy deliveries to challenging Yorkers, every question brings a new opportunity to score. With strategic gameplay, quick decisions, and teamwork, participants compete to build the highest score. MPL transforms mathematics into an exciting virtual cricket experience where every ball is a question and every answer counts!

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2. Game Composition

- **Number of Teams:** 2
- **Players per Team:** 11 (10 Players + 1 RMC Mentor)
- **Total Participants:** 22 (20 Players + 2 RMC Mentors)

RMC Mentors Role

Each team will have one Ramanujan Maths Club (RMC) Mentor who acts as a guide and representative throughout the Mathematics Premier League. The mentor coordinates communication between the team and organizers, assists with clarifications regarding game rules, and represents the team during disputes. They also support fair play, encourage teamwork, and help ensure smooth participation throughout the match.

Each team will have a batting lineup finalized before the match.

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3. Match Format

- Each match consists of two innings.
- Innings 1: Team 1 bats, Team 2 bowls.
- Innings 2: Team 2 bats, Team 1 bowls.
- Each innings consists of a fixed number of questions.
- The total number of questions per innings will be finalized by the organizers.
- The team with the higher total runs after both innings wins.

4. Question & Run Allocation

Each question is assigned a run value, difficulty level, and ball type.

Run Value Type of Ball Difficulty Number of Questions

Run Value	Type of Ball	Difficulty	Number of Questions
1 Run	Normal Ball	Very Easy	Fixed
2 Runs	Normal Ball	Easy	Fixed
4 Runs	Normal Ball	Medium	Fixed
6 Runs	Normal Ball	Hard	Fixed
Variable	Bouncer	Reduced Time	Fixed
Variable	Yorker	Toughest Question	Fixed
Variable	Full Toss	Easy Question, Higher Score	Fixed

Total Questions per Innings: Fixed by the organizers.

The distribution of normal balls and special balls will be finalized before the event to ensure balanced gameplay.

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5. Game Flow & Rules

5.1 Toss Phase

- A virtual toss decides which team gets the first choice.
- The toss-winning team chooses whether to bat or bowl first.
- Batting and bowling lineups are finalized before the match.

5.2 Batting & Bowling Turns

Step 1: Player Selection

- The batting team selects the next batter according to the pre-decided batting lineup.
- The bowling team selects a question for the batter.
- The bowler is chosen according to the predetermined reverse-order bowling system.

Step 2: Answer Selection

- The batter receives a mathematical question with a specified time limit.
- The batter will have the option to select an answer from the given choices.
- The answer must be submitted before the timer expires.

Step 3: Scoring

- If the batter answers correctly, the assigned runs are awarded.
- If the batter answers incorrectly and time remains, the bowler gets an opportunity to answer.
- If the bowler answers correctly within the remaining time, the batter is out.

- If the bowler fails to answer correctly, the delivery becomes a dot ball.
- If the timer expires before the batter submits an answer, it is a dot ball.

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6. Streak Bonus

The Streak Bonus rewards consecutive successful answers and introduces additional scoring opportunities.

6.1 Batting Team Streak Bonus

- If the batting team answers **3 consecutive questions correctly**, they receive bonus runs.
- The bonus is awarded after the third consecutive correct answer.
- The streak counter resets when the batter gives an incorrect answer or fails to answer.
- The bonus value will be finalized by the organizers.

Suggested Rule: A batting streak of 3 consecutive correct answers earns +2 bonus runs.

6.2 Bowling Team Streak Bonus

- If the batting team fails to answer 3 consecutive questions correctly, the bowling team earns a bonus.
- A run deduction is applied to the batting team's total.
- The deduction is applied after the third consecutive unsuccessful batting attempt.
- The streak counter resets when the batting team answers correctly.

Suggested Rule: 3 consecutive unsuccessful batting attempts result in −2 runs for the batting team.

Note: The exact bonus and deduction values can be adjusted by the organizers for balanced gameplay.

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7. Power Shot

The Power Shot is a special batting option that allows the batter to double the runs awarded for a selected delivery.

Rules

- **Each team will have only one Power Shot per innings.**
- The batting team can choose when to use its Power Shot.
- The batter selects the Power Shot before answering the question.
- If the batter answers correctly, the runs awarded for that ball are doubled.
- If the batter answers incorrectly, the doubled runs are not awarded.
- The bowler does not receive a wicket opportunity on a Power Shot delivery.

- Once used, the team's Power Shot cannot be used again during that innings.
- The Power Shot provides the batting team with a strategic, luck-based scoring opportunity.

Example:

- Normal run value: 4 runs.
- Power Shot selected.
- Batter answers correctly.
- Total runs awarded: 8 runs.

Each team receives one Power Shot per innings.

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8. Question Variations

Question Variations introduce different challenges and scoring opportunities.

8.1 Bouncer

- A Bouncer is a question with a reduced answering time.
- The batter receives 10 seconds less than the actual question timer.
- The question may retain its original run value.
- This variation tests the batter's speed and decision-making.

8.2 Yorker

- A Yorker is the toughest question variation.
- It contains a challenging mathematical problem.
- It tests the batter's conceptual understanding and problem-solving ability.
- The difficulty level is higher than a regular question.

8.3 Full Toss

- A Full Toss is an easy question with a higher run value.
- It provides the batter with an opportunity to score more runs.
- The question has a lower difficulty level but a higher reward.
- This variation introduces strategic scoring opportunities.

The difficulty, run value, and time limit for each variation will be finalized by the organizers.

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9. Answer Selection & Power Shot

- The batter will be provided with multiple answer choices for each question.
- The batter selects the answer before the timer expires.

- The Power Shot must be selected before answering the question.
- Each team can use only one Power Shot per innings.
- Question variations will be displayed clearly to the batter.
- The Power Shot and question variation rules will be announced before the delivery begins.

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10. Legal and Illegal Deliveries

Legal Delivery

- Counts toward the fixed number of questions in the innings.
- The batter attempts the selected question.
- Runs are awarded based on the result.

Wide Ball

- Does not count toward the fixed legal delivery limit.
- The batting team receives 1 extra run.
- The bowler selects the next question.
- The same batter continues.

No Ball

- Does not count toward the fixed legal delivery limit.
- The batting team receives 1 extra run.
- The batter selects the next question.
- The same batter continues.

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11. Innings Progression

- Each innings continues until the fixed number of questions is completed or all players are out.
- If a player is dismissed, the next batter enters according to the batting lineup.
- Extra deliveries follow the announced rules.
- Teams switch batting and bowling roles after the first innings.

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12. Match Outcome

The winner is determined by the total runs scored after both innings.

Tie-Breaking Rules

1. If both teams have equal runs, the team with more boundaries (4s and 6s) wins.
2. If boundaries are also equal, the team that used less total answering time wins.

For knockout or league advancement:

- Higher total runs take priority.
- If runs are equal, wickets taken are compared.
- If wickets are also equal, total answering time is compared.

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13. Online Match Setup

- Matches can be conducted through an online platform such as Google Meet.
- Player names can be entered manually or imported from a CSV file.
- The toss is conducted virtually.
- The question, timer, answer options, and scoring should be visible to participants.
- If a player is absent, the team continues with available players according to the lineup rotation rules.

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14. Special Notes

- Each team must coordinate with its RMC Mentor for clarifications and disputes.
- The organizers will finalize the total number of questions per innings.
- The organizers will determine the scoring values for Streak Bonuses and Power Shots.
- Question difficulty, ball types, and time limits must be reviewed before the match.
- All teams must follow the announced rules to ensure fair play.
- Each team will have one Power Shot per innings.
- The organizers may adjust the number of special deliveries based on match duration and gameplay balance.